

Completing your IR35 questionnaire

You've been asked to complete a short questionnaire so the end-hirer can determine your IR35 (off-payroll) status for an assignment. It takes about ten minutes.

Why you're doing this

Your answers, alongside the hirer's, feed a **Status Determination Statement (SDS)** — the formal decision on whether your engagement sits inside or outside IR35. The **hirer makes the final determination**; your job is to describe how you actually work, accurately.

1 Signing in

1. Open the link you were sent (ir35-workbench.ascend-people.ai/<your-client>/) and enter the **access code provided to you**.
2. Type your name, then choose **Contractor**.
3. You'll only ever see **your own** questionnaire and your own SDS — nothing about other workers.

2 Before you start — have these to hand

- Your **contract** for this assignment (with the agency or client).
- How you work **in practice**: substitution rights, who directs your work, how / where / when you work, how you're paid, and what equipment you use.

3 Completing the questionnaire

1. Answer each question about **this specific engagement** and how you **actually** work — not how you'd like it to be.
2. Most questions are **three-way** (for example: yes / it depends / no). Choose the one that best reflects reality.
3. Where a question offers a **notes box**, add a sentence of context — especially for anything that isn't clear-cut. This is useful evidence.
4. Answer **honestly and completely**. An accurate picture protects you as well as the hirer.

4 What the questions cover

- **Substitution** — could someone else do the work in your place, and who would arrange and pay them?
- **Control** — who decides how, when and where the work is done?
- **Mutuality of obligation** — is there any obligation to offer and accept ongoing work, or is it tied to a defined project?
- **Business on your own account** — do you work for other clients, carry costs or financial risk, use your own equipment, and put right defective work at your own cost?

5 What happens next

- Your answers combine with the hirer's assessment. If the picture is clear, an **SDS is produced**. If it's **borderline**, a qualified specialist reviews it before any decision is made.

- You'll be able to **see your SDS** once it's issued. If you disagree with the determination, you can **raise it with the hirer**.

6 A note on honesty

This isn't a test to "pass". A correct, well-evidenced status — inside or outside — protects everyone. Guessing, or overstating your independence, can create problems later.

Ascend IR35 Workbench — Ascend Workforce Solutions IP. Decision-support, not legal advice; the status determination is made by the end-hirer. Ruleset v0.3 (provisional). Questions about access: contact the hirer who invited you.